3. Weighted Grades & Act 95

From the January Act 95 hearing to the November Board meeting: the working document, timeline, emails and the caregiver survey.

Working Document

Agenda (2/26/26)

Invitees: the Act 95 / weighted grades student group, plus staff: Bryn Horton, Jim Ertel, Jordain Blank, Kristine Wendorf, Michael Morgan, Peggy Shoemaker, Stephanie Leonard, Sarah Chaja-Clardy.

Topics

1. Who else should be at the table? (and who wasn't at the table during Act 95 that should be this time around for the weighted grade conversation)
   - Inviting those who are being impacted most: underclassmen and potentially middle schoolers.
   - Underrepresented groups not currently represented: PPA/JEDI.
   - West ideas: 8th graders/underclassmen getting increased voices; reaching out to club/EC leaders for input on their programs.
   - East ideas: different career tracks (i.e. tech ed); students with different GPAs; students with different club and EC focus.
2. Initial idea generation — how should we collect feedback from students, staff and caregivers?
   - East ideas: If we use so many surveys, students might become desensitized and may not fill them out accurately. Surveys are still the best way to access caregivers and teachers.
   - West ideas: Surveys for teachers and caregivers; focus groups for students.
3. Sub-team identification (by group at first, later by task):
   - Student (TBD) / Staff (survey) / Caregiver (survey)

To Dos

- A policy brought to the board by end of May, with comprehensive community understanding of the process.

Notes

- NEXT MEETING ON 3/12 (THURSDAY)
- How can we divide the labor to achieve our goals?
- Capturing underclassmen opinion
- How can we accurately represent our student body? PPA/JEDI are underrepresented.
- Reaching out to students and teachers in different ways: more formal via emails from Curt; less formal via peer-to-peer outreach.

- Aim to capture accurate percentages of student body groups (ex: IEP, 504, African American, Free and Reduced Lunch).
- Aim to meet again/have email communication by next Tuesday, 3/2.
- Any questions regarding Infinite Campus should be directed to kkwendo@sunprairieschools.org (Kristine Wendorf).
- People found the focus group to be very effective.

3/12/26 GPA Calculation Notes

- The top page shows our current GPA process (unweighted).
- Sum of GPA weights remains the same; however, the sum (GPA value) is weighted.
- Bonus points have a similar outcome to weighting grades.
- Options: weighting classes on a 5-point scale, or giving bonus points to challenging classes.
- In consensus on using a 5.0 scale rather than awarding bonus points to courses.

Staff survey notes:

- In the survey, include the video from the board meeting and the slideshow created; note shortcomings/nuances.
- After survey data is collected, look at the courses which departments refer to.
- Referring back to the gym class situation: there is no need to weight all of the courses recommended by staff ("easy/mandatory" courses at Madison College, P.E., "Start College Now").
- Prior to spring break.

Next meeting: work on staff/caregiver survey. Additional comment: Should this be implemented for rising freshmen only, or next year's freshmen AND sophomores? Caregiver survey team: Zackary Mark and three other students

Draft 1 — Weighted GPA: Parent & Caregiver Survey

Right now, our district uses an unweighted GPA, where all classes are on the same 4.0 scale (for example, an A = 4.0 in every course). A weighted GPA gives extra grade points for more rigorous courses (such as AP, IB, dual credit, or honors). For example, an A in an AP course might count as 4.5 or 5.0 instead of 4.0. We are exploring whether a weighted GPA system would be appropriate for our district. Your responses will help inform recommendations this spring.

1. What is your relationship to the student(s) you support? (Parent / Legal guardian / Other primary caregiver / Other)
2. What grade level(s) are your student(s) currently in? (6th or below / 7th–8th / 9th / 10th / 11th / 12th / Other)
3. How familiar are you with our current GPA and weighting practices? (Very / Somewhat / A little / Not at all)
4. Have you or your student(s) previously been in a school/district that used a weighted GPA system? (Yes, my student(s) / Yes, I did / No / Not sure / Other)

5. Overall, how do you feel about our district adopting a weighted GPA system? (Strongly support → Strongly oppose)
6. To what extent do you agree (Strongly agree → Strongly disagree): A weighted GPA would meaningfully impact student stress and pressure. / ...would meaningfully impact students' course selection. / ...could unintentionally disadvantage some students (for example, students with less access to advanced courses). / ...would better recognize the rigor of advanced courses (AP, IB, dual credit, honors, etc.).
7. What is one potential benefit you see in adopting a weighted GPA system? (Short answer)
8. What is one potential concern you have about adopting a weighted GPA system? (Short answer)
9. If we move forward, what information or support would be most helpful? (Clear written explanation of how GPA is calculated / Examples of weighted vs. unweighted transcripts / Guidance for talking with my student about course choices / Information sessions / Translated materials / Q&A opportunities / I don't need additional support / Other)
10. Is there anything else you would like the committee to consider? (Short answer)

Draft 2 — Caregiver Survey: Weighted Grades (the "SPE" East-side draft)

SPASD has historically used an unweighted grading/GPA system, with every class being of equal importance on a 4.0 scale. That is, an A in an AP, dual enrollment, or regular level class would all factor into students' GPA as a 4.0, a B as 3.0, and so on. Recently, some students have shown interest in adopting a weighted grading system. With this, certain advanced classes would be graded on a higher scale (ex. 5.0), while regular classes would remain on a 4.0 scale. All responses are completely anonymous.

1. What grade level(s) are your student(s) currently enrolled in? (K-5th / 6th-8th / 9th / 10th / 11th / 12th / Not yet enrolled but will be / No longer enrolled but were previously)
2. What high school(s) are your student(s) enrolled in / will attend? (Sun Prairie East / Sun Prairie West / Prairie Phoenix Academy / Sun Prairie Virtual School (JEDI))
3. On a scale from 1-5 (5 = full support), what would your opinion on SPASD adopting a weighted grading system be?
4. Please elaborate on why you ranked the above question as you did. (Long answer)
5. If SPASD were to adopt a weighted grading system, what classes would you like to see weighted on a higher scale? (AP / Dual enrollment / STEM Academy at Madison College / Early College Credit / Start College Now / Audition music classes / Advanced/capstone electives / Other)
6. Any other questions, comments, or concerns? (Long answer)
7. If you would like to be part of future feedback, include your full name and email. (Short answer)

Review notes comparing the drafts

East: Overall — are we sending this to elementary? Feedback: yes, send to elementary; long-term focus. West: Q1 not needed (relationship data). Q2 similar question — just align. Q3 overall feedback — leave; restructure to focus on which classes to weight. Q4 not necessary. Q5 not necessary — we've established we're going to move forward with weighted

grades. Q7 and Q8 are similar; Q10 is similar and could be combined with Q7 and Q8. Q9 keep — open ended.

Final Survey Draft: Caregiver

Caregiver Survey — Weighted Grades. SPASD has historically used an unweighted grading/GPA system, with every class being of equal importance on a 4.0 scale. Recently, some students have shown interest in adopting a weighted grading system in our district. With this, certain advanced classes would be graded on a higher scale (ex. 5.0), while regular classes would remain on a 4.0 scale. This form is intended to collect data on student caregivers' opinions. All responses are completely anonymous, and all questions are optional.

1. What grade level(s) are your student(s) currently enrolled in?
2. What high school(s) are your student(s) currently enrolled in / will they attend?
3. On a scale from 1-5 (5 being full support, 1 being no support), what would your opinion on SPASD adopting a weighted grading system be?
4. Please elaborate on why you ranked the above question as you did.
5. If SPASD were to adopt a weighted grading system, what classes would you like to see weighted on a higher scale? (See the high school course guide.) AP / Dual enrollment/credit / STEM Academy at Madison College / Early College Credit / Start College Now / Audition music / Advanced/capstone electives / Other
6. What factors did you consider when responding to the above question (ex. rigor, time commitment, college credit)?
7. As SPASD moves forward with weighted grades, what resources would help support your family (ex. information sessions, detailed explanations of our weighting system)?
8. Are there any other questions, comments, or concerns you have regarding this issue?
9. If you would like to be part of future feedback on this topic, please include your full name and email address.

Staff Weighted Grades Informational Survey

A recent district-wide survey of high school students showed that 38% were interested in implementing a weighted grading system for all classes, even though that was not the primary question the survey asked. Further student focus groups supported this statistic. Because of this and ongoing work to decide how to determine which students qualify for Wisconsin Act 95, we are seeking staff feedback on how to effectively implement weighted grading. The school board presentation and video (5:10–56:20) are linked for more information.

1. Which department are you in? (Health and PE / Multilingual Learner / English / Family and Consumer Science / AVID / Agriculture / Art / Business Education / Social Studies / Math / Music / Science / Technology and Engineering / World Languages / Administration / Other)
2. What do you believe should be the priority when considering which courses to weight? (ex: course rigor, effort required, college credit received, number of prerequisites)
3. Are there any courses in your department you would like to see weighted in the future? If so, which and why?

4. If SPASD were to adopt a weighted grading system, which classes would you like to see weighted? (AP / Dual enrollment/credit / STEM Academy / Early College Credit / Start College Now / Audition music / Advanced electives (ex. ProStart) / Other)
5. Any other questions, comments, or concerns?

Weighted Grades — Infinite Campus Information Sharing Doc (linked)

Weighted Grades Meeting — Sept 23, 2026

- Welcome and introductions
- Review of the work and previous decisions
- Picking up where we left off: review only, no discussion. Review of project timeline. Caregiver survey — finalize/complete. Decision points remaining.
- Developing criteria for weighting. Goal: not to name specific classes that should or should not be weighted, but to create criteria that will be applied to classes.
- When to apply weighting
- Choosing future meeting dates (Tuesdays or Thursdays)
- Question for future consideration: Will we implement a valedictorian system?

Weighted Grades Meeting — Oct 1, 2026

- Welcome and introductions
- Review of the work and previous decisions
- Caregiver survey draft — to-do: final version confirmation; sending dates and responsibilities
- Forming sub-teams (to sub or not to sub... that is the question). Possible teams (sign-up): Criteria Team (for classes/weighted grades); Roll-in Team
- Schedule next meeting

Weighted Grades Meeting — Oct 15, 2026

- Welcome and introductions
- Review of the work and previous decisions
- Sub-teams: Criteria Team

Criteria "grounding" activity: Weighted grades should recognize _____ because _____.

Weighted grades should recognize course rigor because we should reflect challenge, effort and talent.

- Recognize the amount of pre-requisites.

Recommendation: a 5.0 weight scale, applied to:

- Capstone classes (inclusive of try-out based music courses, repeatable).
- AP courses.
- Classes that earn industry certification or college credit, except for those classes that are equivalent to courses and/or elective credit offered at the high school, and courses that do not transfer to UW colleges/universities for credit.

What does this mean in practice, and why? For classes that are taken through the STEM program, many are equivalent to credit (like PE) that students would earn at the high school level, and the rigor of those classes is equivalent.

Reference sources: Data Source Doc; Presentation.

- Schedule next meeting

Research: How Other Wisconsin Districts Weight Grades

Wauwatosa (Wauwatosa West & East High)

- Weighted: Advanced Placement and dual credit courses through UW–Green Bay only — even for transfer or virtual courses, only those classes are weighted.
- Scale: .025 credits added for every .5 credits; 5.0 scale.
- Seniors/college admissions: transcripts state that weighted grades were introduced during the 2025–2026 school year.
- Why chosen: accessible to all students at both high schools; taught by Wauwatosa teachers; curriculum integrity has external oversight (College Board for AP; UW–Green Bay for dual enrollment); students can earn college credit.
- Not retroactive for 10th → 12th graders.

Elmbrook (Brookfield East High)

- Adds 0.025 per completed semester/half-credit (total 0.05 extra per one-credit course) on a traditional 4.0 scale.
- Weighted: Advanced Placement, Level 5 World Language, specific advanced classes beyond standard capstones, Early College Credit Program, Start College Now.
- No official class rank.

Middleton

- AP courses on a 5.0 scale.
- Open to weighting more courses after looking at 1–2 years of data.
- Wanted to make the "smallest change possible" because Act 95 only affected about 30 people in each graduating class.
- Concern noted: a weighted GPA could increase pressure on students to take AP courses rather than choosing classes based on their true interests. Weighting other higher-level classes could help.

(Three further district research templates were left blank.)

Links in the original document

- Wisconsin Act 95 text: https://docs.legis.wisconsin.gov/2023/related/acts/95
- SPASD course guide: https://www.sunprairieschools.org/east-high/sun-prairie-high-school-academics/course-guide-scheduling
- Board meeting video: https://u.peg.tv/s/ydwehr
- Board presentation slides: https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1LL67KnNBKLerXPWYQe2-S_p7_-At9B_v2QcT2_1JAXY/edit
- Wauwatosa grading: https://www.wauwatosaschools.org/page/highschoolgrading

- Middleton article: https://mhscardinalchronicle.com/6961/news/mhs-switches-to-weighted-gpas/
- Plus links to the 2026–27 West and East High Student & Family Handbooks, the Elmbrook and Middleton handbooks, and several working Google Docs/Forms.

Project Timeline

Weighted Grades — Project Timeline (transcribed from a handwritten image)

- Mid August — Meet with school admin
- Early September — Meet with student School Board reps
- Mid September — Regroup with Weighted Grades student team: next steps; decisions
- Early October — Draft 1 / meeting. Discussion: In what way should Student Services and faculty be involved in the decision? Draft of policy changes.
- Mid October — Draft 2 / meeting
- Early November — Final draft completed; prepare Board meeting presentation. Board meeting: approval of plan and FIRST READING of policy. Question: Is Board approval required for implementing weighted grades, or just a presentation? Belief that approval is required.
- December — Second and final reading of policy / approval

Work process/documentation: https://docs.google.com/document/d/1wzEWuJ6bJj5WU8qIwLva4d-IpO-RYH54wPTOKaEQeWA/edit

Emails & Meeting Invites

E-113 · Updated invitation: Introductory Meeting – Weighted Grades @ Thu Feb 26, 2026 10:08 – 10:40 (CST)

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark and the Act 95 / Weighted Grades student group, with district staff

Date Feb 26, 2026, 10:11 AM

Meeting: Introductory Meeting – Weighted Grades When: Thursday, February 26, 2026, 10:08–10:40 AM (Central) Organizer: Curtis Mould Staff invited: Bryn Horton, Jim Ertel, Jordain Blank, Kristine Wendorf, Michael Morgan, Peggy Shoemaker, Stephanie Leonard, Sarah Chaja-Clardy (plus the student group)

Description: Sharing draft surveys and feedback for students, staff, caregivers. Working doc: https://docs.google.com/document/d/1wzEWuJ6bJj5WU8qIwLva4d-IpO-RYH54wPTOKaEQeWA/edit

"Greetings! Let's get the weighted grades party started! This will be our kick-off. For starters we'll discuss: 1) Who is interested. If you are not interested in participating, please send me a quick email saying you're not interested. If you cannot attend but are interested, please decline, and do not send me an email — I'll continue to include you..."

E-114 · Invitation: ACT 95 Weighted Grade Team Mtg @ Thu Mar 12, 2026 10:00–10:40 (CDT)

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark and the Act 95 / Weighted Grades work group

Date Feb 26, 2026, 10:52 AM

Meeting: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades When: Thursday, March 12, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Join: Google Meet, ; phone (US) +1 , PIN

Agenda:

- Welcome to new participants
- Review of Caregiver Survey
- Review of Staff Survey
- Discussion of initial student feedback ideas

Attachment: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

E-115 · Re: ACT 95 Weighted Grade Team Mtg

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark and the Act 95 / Weighted Grades work group
Date Mar 18, 2026, 8:49 AM

Greetings all — we will be meeting today, March 18th for the weighted grade conversation. This was on my calendar, but no invite to the large group. If this is unexpected or the process owners for the survey are not available today, I will reschedule upon our return from break. My apologies for the oversight.

E-116 · ACT 95 Weighted Grade Team Mtg

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark and the Act 95 / Weighted Grades work group
Date Mar 20, 2026

Please see linked Staff survey: https://

Meeting: ACT 95 Weighted Grade Team Mtg When: Wednesday, March 18, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Join: Google Meet, ; phone (US) +1 , PIN
Agenda: Survey Team work Attachment: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

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E-117 · Re: ACT 95 Weighted Grade Team Mtg

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark and the Act 95 / Weighted Grades work group
Date Apr 13, 2026, 8:57 AM

Hi all ~

We're getting ready to send out the caregiver survey later this week, and the staff survey is on round 2 of distribution. Look forward to a calendar invite for next week. Thank you!

Curt

E-118 · Caregiver Survey

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark and the Act 95 / Weighted Grades work group
Date Apr 27, 2026

Greetings – please see the attached link for the caregiver survey (Survey LINK IS HERE) – if you are on the survey team – THANK YOU. If you have comments or feedback, please use the comments on the Google Doc (Caregiver Combined tab).

I think we need at least three more meetings: review data; draft recommendation; develop communication and presentation.

Good luck to all of you who have exams – I'll do my best to balance meetings with the upcoming AP season.

Curt Mould Director of Digital Media, Innovation and Strategy | Robotics Advisor Sun Prairie Area School District | 608-834-6531

E-119 · [Student] Weighted GPA

From	A fellow Act 95 group student (on behalf of several students)
To	Curtis Mould
Cc	Zackary Mark
Date	Sep 3, 2026, 12:57 PM

Dear Dr. Mould,

I hope your summer was excellent! A few of us in last year's ACT 95 group were curious if you had anything planned for us to further our work improving the district, such as the weighted GPA program we had in progress last year. We are excited to continue to work with you and make this district a better place for everyone!

We can't wait for your response, thank you!

E-120 · Re: [Student] Weighted GPA

From	Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark and the student who wrote; cc: Jim Ertel, Peggy Shoemaker, Diana McFarland, Bryn Horton, Dr. Antoine Reed, Dr. Taren Turner, Sarah PrankeKlang, the Student School Board Representatives
Date	Sep 4, 2026, 8:19 AM

Good morning!

Welcome back to school — I hope you've had a great start so far.

Thanks for asking — your timing is great.

WE ARE going to continue the weighted grades conversation. This is a topic of continued focus and importance, and our goal is to have a new framework for weighted grades to the Board by the end of November. This timeline is important, because updates need to be included in the course guides which are finalized in December. As you recall, we left the work last spring in a good place, and we will be picking it back up shortly.

I'd also like to introduce you via email to Dr. Taren Turner (Asst. Superintendent of TLE) and Sarah PrankeKlang (Director of Secondary TLE). They will also be playing roles in this work as the process for discussion and approval and we near making significant decisions.

I've copied those already named, and have included your building principals and Student School Board Reps (two of them are on the student grading work team), as well so we are all receiving the same message.

Next steps:

- Connect with Student School Board reps regarding 2026-27 work plan
- Calendar 1st student work group meeting (week of Sept. 14th)

I am assuming since you are reaching out that you are still interested in being a part of the conversation, and therefore I will be sure you're both included on the calendar invitation. More information, including an agenda and a place to capture thoughts/questions/concerns will be sent

out next week.

In the meantime, have a wonderful long weekend. I am looking forward to seeing the work team again soon.

Onward! Curt

E-121 · Invitation: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #1 @ Wed Sep 23, 2026 10:00–10:40 (CDT)

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark and the 2026–27 weighted grades work group (37 people)

Date Sep 14, 2026, 10:18 AM

Meeting: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #1 When: Wednesday, September 23, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Join: Google Meet, ; phone (US) +1 , PIN Note: Conflicted with the Student Senate WIN time, 10:00–10:30 AM.

E-122 · Updated invitation with note: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #1

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark and the 2026–27 weighted grades work group

Date Sep 23, 2026, 8:56 AM

Description changed — ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

"Greetings — we will have a brief introductory conversation today at 10:08 (SP30) — moving forward we will schedule on Tuesdays or Thursdays to avoid conflicts with SPWHS Student Senate meetings. Agenda is included in the notes for this meeting."

When: Wednesday, September 23, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Attachment: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

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E-123 · Invitation: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #2 @ Thu Oct 1, 2026 10:00–10:40 (CDT)

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark and the 2026–27 weighted grades work group (38 people, including Jim Ertel and Sarah PrankeKlang)

Date Sep 23, 2026, 10:30 AM

Meeting: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades When: Thursday, October 1, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Join: Google Meet, ; phone (US) +1 , PIN Agenda is included in the notes for this meeting. Attachment: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

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E-124 · [Student] meeting notes (Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #2)

From a student on the work group

To Zackary Mark and two other students on the work group

Date Oct 1, 2026

Key Outcomes

The team finalized the caregiver survey for weighted grades, incorporating formatting changes and a new question regarding implementation timelines. The survey will be translated into Spanish and distributed early next week. Additionally, the group established a research plan to analyze weighted grading criteria from neighboring school districts before their next meeting.

Decisions Made

- Survey Formatting: Changed multiple-choice questions (1, 2, and 5) to checkboxes to allow for multiple selections.
- Question Enhancements: Converted the "factors considered" and "resources" questions from open-ended to multiple-choice with an "Other" option to increase response rates. Added a follow-up elaboration question for those who select "Other."
- Implementation Timeline: Added a forced-choice question asking caregivers if weighted grades should apply immediately to all current students (retroactively) or only to future students/incoming freshmen.
- Distribution Method: The survey will be sent via Google Forms using Infinite Campus or Blackboard.

Action Items

- District staff: Translate the survey into Spanish and distribute it early next week.
- Student Group: Research student handbooks from specific districts (Wauwatosa, Elmbrook, Middleton, Verona, and Oregon) to identify weighted grading criteria and link findings in the notes document.
- Sarah PrankeKlang: Create a dedicated "homework" tab in the notes document for district research.

Next Steps

- Next Meeting: Scheduled for October 15th.
- Agenda for Oct 15: Review the collected caregiver survey data and develop specific criteria for applying grade weighting based on the district research.

E-125 · Invitation: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #3 @ Thu Oct 15, 2026 10:00–10:40 (CDT)

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark and the 2026–27 weighted grades work group (38 people)

Date Oct 1, 2026

Meeting: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #3 When: Thursday, October 15, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Agenda is included in the notes for this meeting. Attachment: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

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E-126 · Invitation: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #2 @ Tue Oct 20, 2026 10:00–10:40 (CDT)

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark and the 2026–27 weighted grades work group (38 people)

Date Oct 19, 2026, 9:10 AM

Meeting: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #2 (invite title as sent) When: Tuesday, October 20, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Agenda is included in the notes for this meeting. Attachment: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

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E-127 · Updated invitation: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #2 @ Tue Oct 20, 2026 10:00–10:40 (CDT)

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark and the 2026–27 weighted grades work group

Date Oct 20, 2026, 10:01 AM

This event has been updated. Changed: conferencing (new Google Meet link). When: Tuesday, October 20, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Agenda is included in the notes for this meeting. Attachment: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

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E-128 · Spreadsheet shared with you: "Sun Prairie Schools Weighted Grades: Caregiver Survey (Responses)"

From Curtis Mould (via Google Sheets) <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark and the weighted grades work group

Date Oct 21, 2026

Curtis Mould has invited you to comment on the following spreadsheet: Sun Prairie Schools Weighted Grades: Caregiver Survey (Responses).

"You are all now able to see the survey results from caregivers. Like last year, I will need an astute member of the student team to make sense of these results, conduct the analysis and identify the most salient nuggets and do so promptly. I'll leave it to you to decide who.

Best - Dr. Mould"

(Zackary's analysis, dated Oct 22, is in the Caregiver Survey: Key Findings section.)

E-129 · Nov 2nd meeting

From	Curt Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark and four other student work group members
Cc	Dr. Taren Turner, Tara Vandehei, Melissa Grayson, Amanda Davis
Date	Oct 29, 2026, 1:51 PM

Greetings! The teaching and learning committee meeting has posted for next Monday, and one of the items on the agenda is weighted grades. This would be a fairly informal discussion with board members about the process and the decisions and to answer any questions that might come up. This meeting is very conversational, and while it is a formal board committee, it does not have the same formality as a full board meeting (we are all sitting around a table). We will not need to have a presentation ready, but I will have the one pager ready.

Are any of you able to join the meeting next week? It occurs from 445 until 545, and meets at the district office on Bird Street.

Please reply and let me know.

Thank you,

Curt Mould Director of Digital Media, Innovation and Strategy · Robotics Advisor · Sun Prairie Area School District · 608-834-6531

E-130 · Weighted Grades: Student Participation on November 2 and November 9

From	Zackary Mark
To	Dr. Curtis Mould
Date	Oct 29, 2026, 7:32 PM

Dear Dr. Mould,

I hope you are doing well. Thank you again for including students in the weighted grades work group. As the plan moves to the Board, I would like to confirm a few details so that students can prepare and so that I can share accurate information with students and families.

1. **Board of Education meeting (November 9):** What role would you like students to have in the presentation, and approximately how much time will we have? Should students who wish to speak during public comment register in advance?
2. **Final vote:** Has a date been set for the Board's final vote? I understand the goal is to finalize the plan in time for the December course guides, and I would like to let students and families know when it will be decided.
3. **Caregiver survey:** May the key findings from the October 22 caregiver survey be shared publicly? Students have asked how families responded, and I want to report it accurately.

Once I have these details, I will share the dates and any public comment instructions through SPASD Student Voice so that interested students and families can participate.

Thank you for your time and for your leadership on this work.

Respectfully,

Zack Mark — Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School

E-131 · Re: Nov 2nd meeting

From	Zackary Mark
To	Dr. Curtis Mould and the student work group
Date	Oct 29, 2026, 2:58 PM

I unfortunately will not be able to attend the Committee Meeting on the second of November, due to a work conflict. Please let me know, however, if anything changes.

Best, Zack Mark

E-132 · Re: Nov 2nd meeting (replies)

From	Dr. Curtis Mould and four student work group members
To	The work group, Dr. Taren Turner, Tara Vandehei, Melissa Grayson, Amanda Davis
Date	Oct 29–30, 2026

Between Oct 29 and Oct 30, four students from West and East replied that they could attend. Dr. Mould: "Glad you can attend! Tara, can you add [the student] to the invitation, please?"

E-133 · For Monday's committee meeting: what families said

From	Zackary Mark
To	The four student work group members attending Nov 2; Dr. Curtis Mould
Date	Oct 30, 2026, 11:17 AM
Attachments	Caregiver Survey: Key Findings (PDF)

Hi all,

Thanks for going to the Teaching and Learning Committee meeting on Monday. I can't make it because of work, so I wanted to pass along a few things that might help if Board members ask questions.

From the caregiver survey (531 responses, October 16–22): a short summary of support, the timing split between families of current high schoolers and families with younger kids, which classes families want weighted and why, and how many asked for a clear written explanation. It's worth having a clear answer for why we chose to start with next year's freshmen (current students already picked their classes under the old rules), and a good written FAQ will matter.

(The caregiver figures are in the Caregiver Survey: Key Findings section.)

If you get a chance afterward, could you let me know what questions came up and whether a date was set for the final vote? Thanks again!

Zack

E-134 · Re: For Monday's committee meeting: what families said

From A student work group member
To Zackary Mark, the other student members, Dr. Mould
Date Oct 30, 2026, 2:48 PM

Thank you for putting this together Zack! We will make sure to keep you updated.

E-135 · Re: For Monday's committee meeting: what families said

From Another student work group member
To Zackary Mark, the other student members, Dr. Mould
Date Oct 30, 2026, 7:31 PM

Thank you so much Zack!

E-136 · Shared with the work group: weighted grades presentation and staff survey

From Dr. Curtis Mould (via Google Drive)
To Zackary Mark and the student work group
Date Nov 2, 2026, 11:04–11:25 AM

Dr. Mould shared three files on the morning of the November 2 committee meeting:

- "ACT95 – Weighted Grades Presentation" (Google Slides), for the November 9 Board meeting
- "Staff Weighted Grades Informational Survey (Responses)" (Google Sheets)
- "Analysis: Staff Weighted Grades Informational Survey" (Google Docs)

(The staff survey analysis is a school-account file this record can't open; it will be added if a copy is provided.)

E-137 · Invitation: Presentation Rehearsal @ Mon Nov 9, 2026 5:00–6:00 PM (CST)

From Dr. Curtis Mould
To Zackary Mark and six other student work group members
Date Nov 3, 2026, 3:28 PM

Presentation Rehearsal. Meet in Room 200 at the PLC, 220 Kroncke Drive. Board meeting starts at 6. When: Monday, November 9, 2026, 5:00–6:00 PM (Central)

E-138 · Invitation: Weighted Grade Convo @ Tue Nov 17, 2026 10:00–10:40 AM (CST)

From Dr. Curtis Mould

To Zackary Mark, the student work group, Sarah PrankeKlang, Peggy Shoemaker, Dr. Taren Turner, Jim Ertel

Date Nov 3, 2026, 3:30 PM

Weighted Grade Convo, on Google Meet. When: Tuesday, November 17, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central)

E-139 · A family FAQ on weighted grades, for your review

From Zackary Mark

To Dr. Curtis Mould

Date Nov 6, 2026, 1:30 PM

Hi Dr. Mould,

Since most caregivers asked for a clear written explanation, I drafted a short family FAQ on the SPASD Student Voice site using only what's been shared publicly. After November 9, I plan to add the Board's questions and the students' answers. Would you be willing to review it for accuracy? It's on the Updates tab at spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-140 · Re: A family FAQ on weighted grades, for your review

From Dr. Curtis Mould

To Zackary Mark

Date Nov 6, 2026, 1:46 PM

Thank you, this link is blocked by our internal filter. Can you place in a Google Doc that can be shared easily?

Curt

On November 8, after learning the Student Voice site is blocked on the school network, Zackary sent the family weighted grades FAQ to Dr. Mould as a PDF, and the Act 95 checklist and course-type chart to Mr. Medema as a PDF.

On November 10, the Sun Prairie West welcome center reserved Conference Room 1006 so the student work group could join the November 17 Weighted Grade Convo together.

Caregiver Survey: Key Findings (October 22, 2026)

Released for the public record after Dr. Mould said the findings could be shared (per Zackary, November 10, 2026).

Written by Zackary for the weighted grades work group, October 22, 2026, after Dr. Mould asked a student to analyze the caregiver survey. The raw responses are not reproduced here because some families left names and emails for follow-up.

The short version

531 caregivers answered in the first week, and 70% support weighted grades. The biggest risk for the plan is timing, not whether to weight.

1. Support is strong and even. 70% rated it a 4 or 5. Support was about the same at West (68%) and East (73%).
2. Timing splits by family. Caregivers of current high schoolers want it applied now, 69% to 31%. Families with only younger kids want to start next year, 74% to 26%. Our Oct 20 plan starts with next year's freshmen, so the families most invested are the ones it leaves out.
3. Rigor is the reason. Supporters say over and over that harder classes should count more. AP is the clear favorite to weight (85%).
4. Opponents worry about fairness and simplicity. The top reasons: all classes have value, keep the 4.0 simple, and students without access to AP fall behind.
5. Families want it explained. 72% asked for a detailed written explanation. Undecided caregivers mostly said they need more information, not that they disagree.

Who answered

531 responses came in from Oct 16 to Oct 22, and 62% arrived on the first day (328).

- Families with a current high schooler (grades 9–12): 320
- Families with only K–8 students: 204
- Sun Prairie West families: 263
- Sun Prairie East families: 245
- Other or no school listed (virtual, Prairie Phoenix, blank): 23

Families could list more than one grade, so the rows overlap. The East and West counts are close, so neither school's families dominate the results.

Support for weighted grades

70% of caregivers support weighted grades, and only 19% oppose them (526 ratings). Support barely changes by group: 68% at West, 73% at East, and 70% for families both with and without a current high schooler. Opposition is strong among the few who hold it: most opponents chose 1, not 2.

When it should start

Overall it's close to a tie, but the split by family is large (462 clear timing answers): families with a current high schooler want it now, and families with younger kids want to wait. Each group mostly picked the option that helps their own child. That's normal, but it means the families with the most at stake are the ones our plan leaves out. 61 caregivers skipped this question, mostly people who oppose weighting entirely.

Which classes, and why

AP is the clear favorite: 85% want AP weighted. That matches our recommendation.

- Classes to weight: AP 85% · dual enrollment 46% · STEM Academy 17%
- Factors they weighed: rigor 75% · college credit 57% · time commitment 56%
- How they want to learn about it: detailed written explanation 72% · information sessions 40%

The course list in our export is cut off, so options listed after STEM (including capstones) can't be counted. The full spreadsheet would fix that. Rigor beating college credit supports our choice to weight capstones, not only classes that earn credit.

What families wrote

388 caregivers explained their rating. Supporters mostly talk about effort, while opponents talk about fairness. Quotes are anonymous and copied as written.

- Support (4–5), 276 explained: harder classes should count more (about half name rigor, effort or AP); Act 95 and direct admit; other districts already do it; the current system discourages AP. "Harder schedules should be rewarded." · "Extra incentive to take advanced classes" · "This is long overdue!"
- Unsure (3), 41 explained: need more information; want the pros, cons and reasoning first. "Need more information. Pros and cons." · "Hate to pressure students"
- Oppose (1–2), 70 explained: all classes have equal value; keep the 4.0 simple; equity for students without AP access; stress; colleges recalculate GPA anyway. "Every class should have equal importance." · "The scale stops at 4 for a reason." · "It's not equitable"

A warning sign about the survey itself: a few opponents said it reads as if the decision is already made. The timing question had no "don't adopt it" option, and 44 caregivers who rated it a 1 skipped that question. The communication package should show that feedback can still change the plan.

Questions families want answered

147 caregivers left a comment or question. These five came up most and belong in the communication package's FAQ.

1. Does it apply to my student, and when does it start? The most common question (about 23 comments), often about a current junior or senior. Some asked whether GPAs would be recalculated going back.
2. How does it affect Act 95 and college admissions? Families asked how it ties to the Wisconsin guarantee and whether colleges use the weighted GPA.

3. Which classes count? People asked about audition music classes, electives, dual credit and capstones. Some said college credit alone shouldn't earn a weight.
4. Is it fair to students without access? Families asked whether every student can get into weighted classes.
5. Why change now, and is it already decided? A few wanted the reasons behind the change and proof the survey matters.

Recommendations for the work group

- Oct 27 (work group): decide how we answer families of current high schoolers before anything goes public. Option A: keep "next year's freshmen only" and give a short, honest reason, for example that current students chose classes under the old rules and changing them mid-course isn't fair. Option B: weight classes taken from 2027–28 on for every student, without recalculating past grades. Either way, say plainly that past grades won't be recalculated.
- One-page communication package: lead with the reason (rigor), list exactly which classes count, and add a five-question FAQ built from the section above. 72% asked for a written explanation, so the written piece matters more than events.
- Nov 2 and Nov 9 (Board): bring three numbers: 70% caregiver support, 78% of students choosing a weighted option in the Act 95 survey, and the 69% to 31% timing split. Name the split ourselves rather than letting Board members hear it first from parents.
- Address equity directly. Opponents' strongest point is access. Show how students get into AP and capstone classes and what support exists, so weighting doesn't look like a reward only for students who already have access.

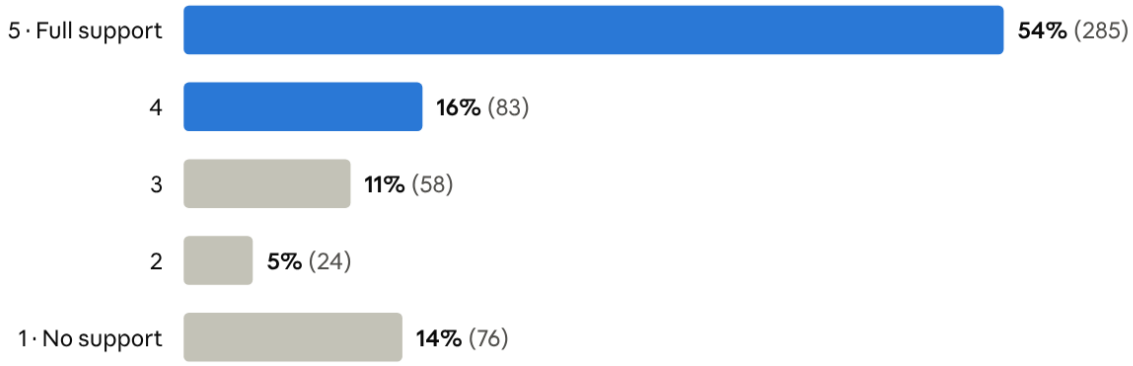
Method and limits

- Source: the PDF export of the caregiver survey responses (531 rows, Oct 16–22). Percentages are of all 531 unless a question's own count is given.
- The survey is self-selected, so it shows who chose to answer, not every family in the district.
- The PDF cuts long answers off after about 45 characters. Comment themes are based on those first words, so treat the theme counts as rough.
- Student comparison figures come from the Dec 2025 – Jan 2026 Act 95 student survey (903 responses).
- Names and emails that some families left for follow-up are not included.

Most caregivers support weighted grades

70% rated it a 4 or 5 · 526 caregivers answered

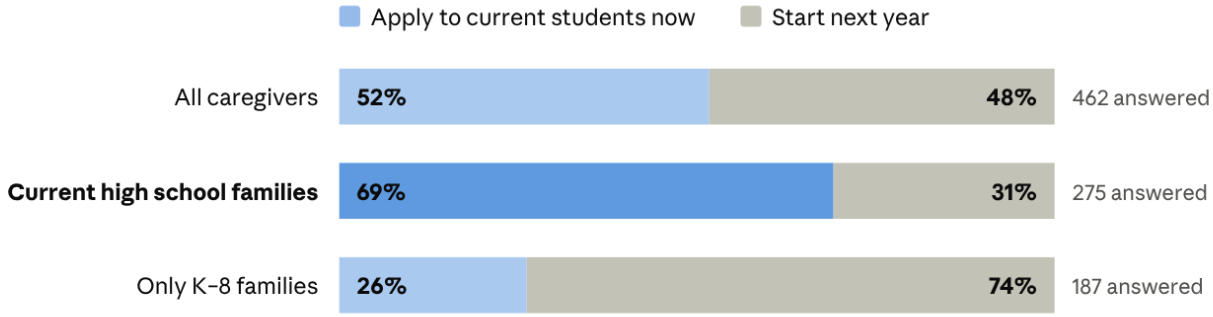
Blue = support (4 or 5). Scale: 1 = no support, 5 = full support.



Support for weighted grades, caregiver survey

Families of current high schoolers want it applied now

When should weighted grades start? Share of each group that answered



Work group plan (Oct 20): start with next year's freshmen. Blanks and unreadable answers left out.

When it should start, by family